

RESPONSE TO ORDER TO SHOW CAUSE AND RENEWED MOTION TO DENY FALSE PPO VIOLATION CLAIMS

Source PDF: PPO_Show_Cause_Response_Signed.pdf

Pages: 24

Case: 26-102221-PP, Wayne County Third Circuit Court (PPO docket)

Author: Conrad Alan Rockenhaus, Respondent (pro se)

Text extracted from embedded OCR layer of source PDF.

PAGE 1

STATE OF MICHIGAN

THIRD JUDICIAL CIRCUIT, WAYNE COUNTY

ADRIENNE MARJORIE ROCKENHAUS, Case No.: 26-102221-PP

Petitioner, Hon.: Yvonna C. Abraham

v.

CONRAD ALAN ROCKENHAUS,

Respondent.

RESPONDENT'S RESPONSE TO ORDER TO SHOW CAUSE AND
RENEWED MOTION TO DENY FALSE PPO VIOLATION CLAIMS,
FOR DISMISSAL OF SHOW CAUSE, AND FOR SANCTIONS

NOW COMES Respondent, Conrad Alan Rockenhaus, appearing pro se, and respectfully submits this Response to the Order to Show Cause entered March 9, 2026, and renews his Motion to Deny False PPO Violation Claims. Respondent moves this Court to dismiss the show cause proceeding in its entirety for the following reasons: (1) the Personal Protection Order was never properly served on Respondent as required by MCR 3.706 and MCL 600.2950(18); (2) Respondent's presence at 26695 Ross Drive on March 2, 2026 did not constitute a knowing violation of the PPO because he had no proper notice of its existence or terms; (3) the alleged proxy harassment violations of March 29-30, 2026 were perpetrated by anonymous third-party internet actors, not Respondent, as Petitioner's own public social media posts establish; and (4) Petitioner has engaged in a pattern of bad faith conduct designed to manufacture grounds for Respondent's arrest. In support thereof, Respondent states:

I. THRESHOLD ISSUE: THE PPO WAS NEVER PROPERLY SERVED ON
RESPONDENT

PAGE 2

1. A contempt finding for violation of a PPO requires as a threshold matter that the PPO was properly served on the respondent. MCR 3.706(D) and MCL 600.2950(18) require that a personal protection order be served on the respondent either: (a) personally by a third party handing the respondent a physical copy; (b) by a process server or court officer; or (c) by restricted delivery certified mail with the respondent's signature on the return receipt. None of these methods were used.
2. On March 2, 2026, the day of Respondent's release from federal custody, Respondent arrived at 26695 Ross Drive, Redford Township, Michigan, a property on which he was a named tenant under a valid lease. Respondent had no prior knowledge that a PPO had been filed. Neither Petitioner nor any process server personally handed Respondent a physical copy of the PPO at any point.
3. The Redford Township Police Department responded to the scene on March 2, 2026.

According to Redford Township Police Department Report CR No. 260003379, the responding officer read the conditions of the PPO to Respondent from Petitioner's cell phone screen. Respondent was then given photographs of the PPO taken with a neighbor's cell phone so he could, in the officer's words, 'appeal the PPO.' No physical copy of the PPO was served on Respondent. The officer completed a proof of service at the station despite the fact that Respondent never received an actual physical copy of the order. The Redford Township Police Department report further confirms that Respondent was not in violation of the PPO by being present at 26695 Ross Drive, a property on which he was a named tenant under a valid lease. The Redford Township Police Department Report CR No. 260003379 is attached hereto as Exhibit B. Reading an order aloud from a cell phone screen and providing cell phone photographs of the order are not recognized methods of PPO service under MCR 3.706 or MCL 600.2950(18). The officer's own completion of a proof of service at the station under these circumstances does not cure the defective service.

4. Prior to March 2, 2026, Petitioner's attorney sent an email to Respondent's federal attorney Kaycee Berente notifying her of the PPO's existence. Notifying a respondent's attorney of a PPO's existence is not proper service on the respondent. Service must be made on the respondent personally, not on their counsel.

PAGE 3

5. Following March 2, 2026, Respondent's nephew-in-law Robby Hein emailed Respondent a copy of the PPO. Service by email from a family member does not constitute proper service under MCR 3.706 or MCL 600.2950(18). Furthermore, Respondent subsequently lost access to that email account when an unknown party successfully accessed the account using Respondent's date of birth, zip code, and mother's maiden name.
6. Petitioner obtained the PPO on February 20, 2026. Respondent was not released from federal custody until March 2, 2026. Petitioner therefore had ten full days to arrange proper service on Respondent through the BOP prior to his release. The BOP regularly facilitates service of civil process on inmates. Petitioner made no attempt to properly serve Respondent during this ten-day window despite having ample time and opportunity to do so. Her failure to arrange proper service before Respondent's release date, and her apparent decision instead to simply notify his attorney by email, demonstrates either a deliberate choice to avoid proper service or a failure to comply with her obligations under MCR 3.706.
7. Because the PPO was never properly served on Respondent pursuant to the requirements of MCR 3.706 and MCL 600.2950(18), Respondent cannot be held in contempt for any alleged violation. The show cause proceeding must be dismissed as a threshold matter.

II. MARCH 2, 2026 -- RESPONDENT HAD NO KNOWING NOTICE OF THE PPO

PAGE 4

7. Even setting aside the improper service issue, Respondent's presence at 26695 Ross Drive on March 2, 2026 cannot constitute a knowing violation of the PPO.
8. Respondent was released from federal custody on March 2, 2026. He was released to the address of 26695 Ross Drive, Redford Township, Michigan, a property on which his name appears as a named tenant on a valid lease effective September 1, 2025 through August 31,
9. Respondent had a legal right to be present at this address.
10. At the time Respondent arrived at Ross Drive, he had not been properly served with the PPO. His attorney had been notified of its existence by email, but Respondent had not

personally received a copy. Respondent learned of the PPO's existence only when Ann Helgren, a mutual acquaintance, informed him upon his arrival that a PPO had been filed. Sonia McCain, Police Co-Response Clinician for the Redford Township Police Department, later confirmed in writing that the PPO was served verbally to Respondent, further establishing that no proper physical service was accomplished. Ms. McCain's written confirmation is attached hereto as Exhibit C. The Redford Township Police then arrived and read the PPO conditions to Respondent from Petitioner's phone screen.

11. Contempt for violation of a court order requires that the alleged contemnor had knowledge of the order at the time of the alleged violation. Because Respondent had not been properly served with the PPO and had no actual notice of its terms prior to arriving at Ross Drive, his presence at that address on March 2, 2026 cannot constitute a knowing violation of the PPO.
12. The Redford Township Police Department officer who responded on March 2, 2026, independently assessed the situation and determined that the circumstances did not warrant Respondent's arrest. This is consistent with Respondent's position that no knowing PPO violation occurred.

III. ANNE HELGREN -- PETITIONER'S OWN CONDUCT ON MARCH 2 UNDERMINES HER CLAIMS

PAGE 5

12. The events involving Ann Helgren on March 2, 2026 further demonstrate that the alleged violations were not the result of Respondent's aggression or harassment, but were rather the product of Petitioner's own calculated conduct designed to harm Respondent.
13. On March 2, 2026, Ms. Helgren, a mutual acquaintance, came to Ross Drive when she learned of the situation. She offered to transport Respondent and did so, taking him to her home after the police had assessed the scene and declined to take action.
14. While transporting Respondent, Ms. Helgren received communications from Petitioner instructing her to tell the Veterans Administration that Respondent was suicidal. This statement was false. The Redford Township Police officers had independently assessed Respondent, determined he was not suicidal, and declined to transport him to any hospital.
15. Petitioner further instructed Ms. Helgren to leave Respondent at the VA and abandon him there. When Ms. Helgren resisted these instructions, Petitioner threatened to end their friendship if Ms. Helgren did not comply. This conduct, directing a third party to make false statements to a federal medical institution about Respondent's mental health status, demonstrates that it was Petitioner, not Respondent, who was orchestrating harmful actions on March 2, 2026.
16. Ms. Helgren was visibly distressed by Petitioner's demands and ultimately had to leave Respondent, which she did reluctantly. Ms. Helgren is prepared to provide a sworn statement regarding these communications and her observations on March 2, 2026.

IV. THE ROBBY EMAIL DID NOT VIOLATE THE PPO

PAGE 6

17. Petitioner's show cause motion alleges that Respondent violated the PPO by sending an email to his nephew-in-law Robby Hein in which Respondent asked Robby to relay information to Petitioner. Respondent does not dispute the general authenticity of this email. However, this email does not constitute a PPO violation for the following reasons.
18. The PPO prohibits Respondent from contacting Petitioner directly. It does not prohibit

Respondent from communicating with his own family members, including family members of his spouse. Sending an email to one's nephew-in-law is not a PPO violation.

19. The content of the email demonstrates that Respondent had no harassing or threatening intent. Respondent expressed in the email that he had no desire to contact Petitioner except through lawful channels, offered Petitioner financial support of \$2,000 per month, and expressed concern for her well-being. This is not the conduct of a person attempting to stalk or harass.
20. Furthermore, the fact that Robby Hein chose to forward the email to Petitioner and subsequently requested that Respondent no longer contact him does not transform a lawful communication between family members into a PPO violation. Respondent respected Robby's request and ceased contact with him.
21. To the extent the Court finds any technical issue with the Robby email, the content and context make clear that no threatening or harassing conduct occurred, and any sanction would be disproportionate to the conduct at issue.

V. THE MARCH 29-30, 2026 MESSAGES WERE SENT BY THIRD-PARTY INTERNET ACTORS

PAGE 7

22. Petitioner alleges that Respondent contacted her via anonymous burner phone messages, a Signal account bearing the name Dan Ferris, and by arranging an unsolicited Domino's Pizza delivery on or about March 29-30, 2026. All three of these allegations are false and are directly refuted by Petitioner's own public social media posts.
23. Respondent has never owned or possessed a Motorola Moto G Play or any other Androidbased device. The alleged burner phone messages were sent from a Motorola Moto G Play on the Verizon network. Respondent's sole personal device is an Apple iPhone. This is confirmed by multiple witnesses who had regular daily contact with Respondent during this period and who were prepared to submit sworn affidavits confirming they never observed Respondent in possession of an Android device. Brian Howell's notarized affidavit dated April 10, 2026, is attached hereto as Exhibit A. Redford Township Police Department Report CR No. 260003379 is attached hereto as Exhibit B.
24. Petitioner's own public posts on X.com on March 29-30, 2026 establish conclusively that the messages originated from KiwiFarms, a known internet harassment forum. Petitioner publicly acknowledged she was receiving more texts from KiwiFarms that evening than in her entire online history and explicitly referenced the KiwiFarms origin of the contacts. Petitioner therefore knew or should have known these messages were not from Respondent.
25. One of the messages Petitioner herself published explicitly stated: 'Is your husband just pretending not to care? Can we ruin his night and ask you and Joe to post a selfie? We believe that will make him react to the point to where you could probably get him arrested.' This message demonstrates an explicit coordinated scheme by anonymous third-party internet actors to manufacture a PPO violation and cause Respondent's arrest. Despite possessing this evidence, Petitioner filed PPO violation reports with two separate law enforcement agencies based on these same messages.

PAGE 8

26. Regarding the Signal account bearing the name Dan Ferris: Petitioner herself publicly admitted that the name Dan Ferris was a fictional persona she had invented years ago to help the parties resolve arguments. By her own admission, this name was a private

construct known only to the parties. Any person who had reviewed PACER filings and learned of the case, including the KiwiFarms actors who had contacted Petitioner that same evening, could have used this name to impersonate Respondent. Respondent does not use Signal and did not send any messages through Signal. The Signal interface itself showed a 'Review Carefully' warning indicating an unknown unverified contact with no groups in common, which would not have appeared if Respondent had been the sender, as Petitioner would have had his contact saved.

27. Regarding the Domino's Pizza delivery: the practice of ordering unsolicited food deliveries to a target's address, known as pizza bombing, is a well-documented tactic of coordinated internet harassment campaigns. It is entirely consistent with the KiwiFarms harassment campaign documented herein. Respondent categorically denies ordering any food delivery to Petitioner's address.
28. Both the Ann Arbor Police Department, Officer McHenry, and the Redford Township Police Department independently investigated Petitioner's PPO violation reports on March 30, 2026, found those reports to be without merit, declined to arrest Respondent, and advised Respondent to report Petitioner's conduct to this Court. The independent conclusions of two separate police departments constitute powerful corroborating evidence that Petitioner's allegations lack factual basis.

VI. PETITIONER'S PATTERN OF BAD FAITH WARRANTS SANCTIONS

PAGE 9

29. Petitioner filed duplicative false PPO violation reports with two separate law enforcement agencies on the same day, after her own social media posts established that the messages originated from third-party KiwiFarms actors. Both agencies independently found the reports to be without merit and declined to act.
30. Petitioner publicly declared she had confirmed from a reliable source that the messages came from Respondent's personal device, a demonstrably false statement, while simultaneously acknowledging the KiwiFarms origin of the contacts in her own public posts.
31. Petitioner falsely claimed on social media that Respondent had been removed from the Robert J. Delonis Center. In reality, Respondent executed a lease for permanent housing on March 27, 2026, through a VA-coordinated housing transition. Petitioner's false narrative sought to portray Respondent as a homeless fugitive evading law enforcement.
32. This pattern of filing false reports, making false public statements, and attempting to manipulate third parties including Ms. Helgren into making false statements to law enforcement constitutes a knowing and willful abuse of the PPO process and warrants sanctions under MCR 2.114.

VII. RELIEF REQUESTED

WHEREFORE, Respondent Conrad Alan Rockenhaus respectfully requests that this Honorable Court:

PAGE 10

1. Dismiss the Order to Show Cause in its entirety on the threshold ground that the PPO was never properly served on Respondent pursuant to MCR 3.706 and MCL 600.2950(18);
2. In the alternative, find that Respondent's presence at 26695 Ross Drive on March 2, 2026 did not constitute a knowing violation of the PPO because Respondent had not been properly served and had no actual notice of the PPO's terms prior to arriving at that address;

3. Find that Respondent did not violate the PPO through: (a) the anonymous burner phone messages of March 29-30, 2026, which originated from KiwiFarms actors as established by Petitioner's own social media posts; (b) the Dan Ferris Signal account, which used a fictional name Petitioner herself invented and which Signal flagged as an unknown unverified contact; or (c) the unsolicited Domino's Pizza delivery, consistent with documented KiwiFarms harassment tactics;
 4. Find that the Robby Hein email did not constitute a PPO violation, as it was a lawful communication between family members whose content demonstrated no harassing or threatening intent;
 5. Take judicial notice under MRE 201 of Petitioner's March 29-30, 2026 X.com posts as evidence of: (a) Petitioner's bad faith; (b) Petitioner's knowing dissemination of false accusations; and (c) the coordinated third-party scheme designed to manufacture grounds for Respondent's arrest;
 6. Take judicial notice that both the Ann Arbor Police Department and the Redford Township Police Department independently investigated Petitioner's PPO violation reports, found them to be without merit, declined to arrest Respondent, and advised Respondent to bring the matter to this Court;
 7. Award sanctions under MCR 2.114 against Petitioner for knowingly filing false and duplicative PPO violation reports with two separate law enforcement agencies after her own social media posts established the third-party origin of the messages;
 8. Grant Respondent leave to submit additional witness affidavits from Kevin Chavous and Deandre Connor confirming Respondent's whereabouts and device use during the relevant period; and
 9. Grant any other relief this Court deems just and equitable.
- Respectfully submitted,

PAGE 11

/s/ Conrad A. Rockenhaus
Conrad Alan Rockenhaus, Respondent Pro Se
1690 Brookfield Drive
Ann Arbor, Michigan 48103
(254) 340-7910
crockenhaus@icloud.com
Dated: April 16, 2026

PAGE 12

PAGE 13

EXHIBIT LIST

Exhibit A: Affidavit of Brian Howell, notarized April 10, 2026
Exhibit B: Redford Township Police Department Case Report CR No. 260003379, dated March 2, 2026, confirming PPO was read from Petitioner's cell phone screen and that Respondent was given photographs of the PPO taken with a neighbor's phone
Exhibit C: Email from Sonia McCain, Police Co-Response Clinician, Redford Township Police Department, dated March 9, 2026, confirming the PPO was served verbally to Respondent

PAGE 14

CERTIFICATE OF SERVICE

I, Conrad Alan Rockenhaus, hereby certify that on April 16, 2026, I served a true and correct copy of the foregoing Respondent's Response to Order to Show Cause and Renewed Motion to Deny False PPO Violation Claims upon the following party via both First Class U.S. Mail, postage prepaid, and electronically:

Lisa Baker, Esq., Aldrich Legal Services, PLLC, 276 S. Union Street, Plymouth, MI 48170

Email: lisabaker@aldrichlegalservices.com and kris@aldrichlegalservices.com

/s/ Conrad A. Rockenhaus

Conrad Alan Rockenhaus, Respondent Pro Se

1690 Brookfield Drive

Ann Arbor, Michigan 48103

(254) 340-7910

crockenhaus@icloud.com

PAGE 15

EXHIBIT A

Affidavit of Brian Howell

Notarized April 10, 2026

PAGE 16

PAGE 17

PAGE 18

PAGE 19

EXHIBIT B

Redford Township Police Department

Case Report CR No. 260003379

Dated March 2, 2026

PAGE 20

PAGE 21

PAGE 22

PAGE 23

EXHIBIT C

Email from Sonia McCain

Police Co-Response Clinician

Redford Township Police Department

Dated March 9, 2026

Confirming PPO was served verbally

PAGE 24

Email Correspondence - Redford Township Police Department

Re: PPO Service Confirmation

FROM: Sonia McCain smccain@redfordpd.org

DATE: March 9, 2026

SUBJECT: RE: PPO Service

I do not generate reports. I do know that the PPO was served verbally to your ex, thus if he is violating that you should contact the police as I am not an officer.

Have a Blessed Day,

Sonia McCain

Police Co-Response Clinician

Redford Township Police Dept.
